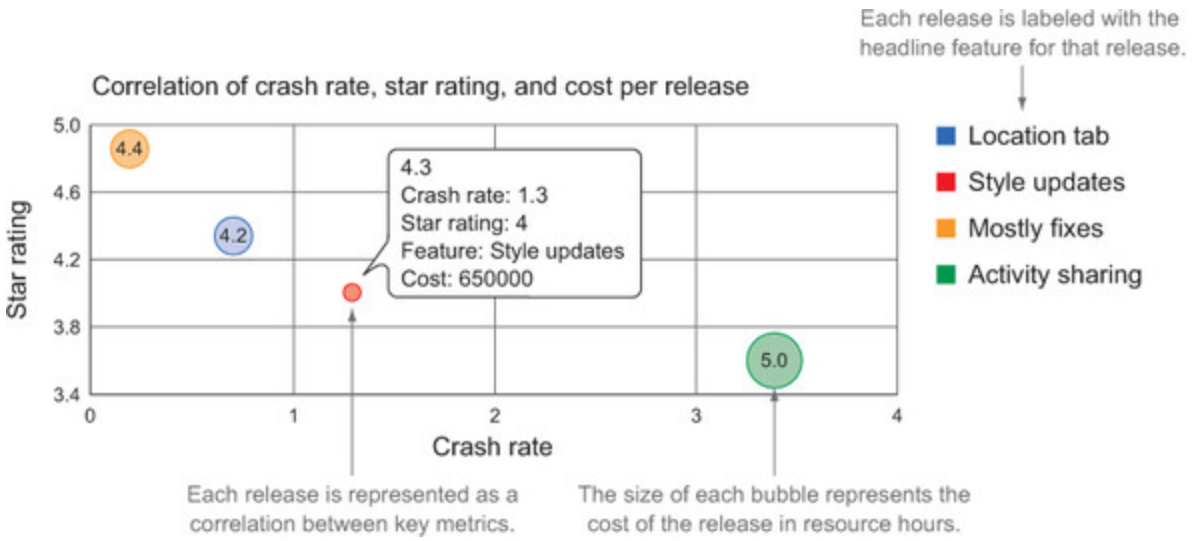
Figure 9.12. An example executive dashboard showing releases sized by cost and measured against crash rate and star rating. Minor releases are much less expensive and tend to be of higher quality.



As you can see in figure 9.12, there's a clear correlation between crash rate and star rating. When the crash rate is low, releases tend to get better ratings. You can also see that the minor releases (4.2, 4.3, 4.4) cost a lot less than the major release (5.0). From an executive point of view it looks like the team is more efficient releasing minor pieces to the app than full-fledged features.

If your team isn't doing so well, then more frequent reports to leadership are usually in order. In those updates you should use the key data points you're tracking to get your team back on track to show that you know the problem, know how to fix it, and are making progress. Demonstrating how changes you're making affect your metrics and that you show progress as they're improving are exactly what leadership wants to see; if there's a problem, at least you understand it, are correcting it, and are tracking it effectively.

9.1.4. Using metrics to prove a point or effect change

Because you've made it this far through this book, you know that metrics are awesome, but you can't get a clear picture without several of them that show different facets of what you're trying to measure. Sometimes someone